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## Turning 40, Living Now

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This edition is special. On **6th August**, I marked a personal milestone — turning **39 → 40**. The same day, I embarked a **10-day Vipassana** & successfully completed — an intense inward journey *with no phone, no reading, no writing, and no external distractions*, focused entirely on observing the mind and body.

As I reflected, I realised both these events connected beautifully: *one about the passage of time, and the other about how to truly live in it.*

### Reflection @ 40

Looking back, the past years have given me:

- **Experiences** that shaped who I am.
- **Knowledge** that guided my choices.
- **People** who became mentors, colleagues, and companions on this journey.

But stepping into this new decade, I found myself asking: *What really matters in how I work, lead, and live?*

### Vipassana & Work: Key Takeaways

The Vipassana technique taught me something profound that translates well to our professional lives:

1. **Live in the present** – not stuck in the past, not anxious about the future. In business, we often over-analyze past failures or future risks. True progress comes from *acting in the now*.
2. **Knowledge ≠ Transformation** – Information and frameworks are important, but what changes outcomes is practice. The teaching emphasized that technique is just **10% knowledge** and **90% application**.
3. **Equanimity in change** – Situations rise and pass. Wins, setbacks, pressure — they all flow. Responding with balance rather than reaction builds stronger leadership.

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### Closing Thought

As I begin my 40s, my mantra is simple: *Live in the present. Apply more, over knowing more. Stay balanced in change.*

If there's one gift from Vipassana I carry forward, it's this:

clarity comes not from thinking more, but from living fully in the now.

PS. Vipassana is a 2,500-year-old meditation technique. Over 10 days of silence — *with no phone, no reading, no writing, and no external distractions* — you train your mind to observe reality as it is. The practice begins with focusing on your breath, then moves deeper into observing subtle sensations across the body. The essence is to observe without reacting, which helps cultivate clarity, focus, and balance.

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Welcome to club 40 Vikas.. 😊 ..keep sharing and inspiring..

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Love this, Vikas

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Loved the read **Vikas**, looking forward to the opportunity to understand your journey during Vipassana and, further your lessons during the integration of these learnings at work and other crucial areas of life.

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Congratulations Vikas.. Enjoy, that's the Mantra

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Definitely worth reading

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